



BRIGHT START TO GAMBHIR-SURYAKUMAR ERA IN T20IS

In Suryakumar Yadav, India seems to have found the **right leader** going into the next T20 World Cup cycle.

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The cool climes of Kandy — sitting at an altitude of 1,400 feet above sea level, the Pallekele Stadium here is one of the highest international cricket venues in the world — combined with a hospitable Sri Lankan side provided the perfect backdrop for India's 3-0 T20I series sweep.

Even the usually hard-to-impress Gautam Gambhir was beaming at

the presentation ceremony after the third T20I in his first outing as the national team coach. His men had the better of the home side throughout, winning the first two games with considerable ease to secure the series.

The third match, though, was hardly straightforward, with India rallying from the precipice of defeat to clinch an incredible win, with its skipper Suryakumar Yadav's leadership skills coming to the fore.

Chasing a middling 138 for a consolation win, Sri Lanka needed just nine runs in the last two overs

when Suryakumar threw the ball to Rinku Singh, who had never bowled on the international stage before. Rinku conceded just three runs and took two wickets, including that of danger man Kusal Perera, who made 46 off 34. That left Sri Lanka needing six from six balls.

With the ball turning a mile, Suryakumar, surprisingly, decided to bring himself on for the final over. Bowling for the first time in T20Is, he gave just five runs to force a Super Over, where India easily defeated Sri Lanka.

Suryakumar's captaincy nous was